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"21st Century Scramble and Partition of Africa: China, Russia, and America - A Financial and Economic Engineering Perspective.

"1. Introduction

This essay aims to mainstream the idea of what I call the 21st Century Scramble and Partition of Africa: The Long View. Why and how is this happening? What are the similarities and differences between the epoch of colonialism and neo-colonialism? How are the ongoing global paradigmatic shifts – the resurgence of Russia and China on the global stage – and the decline of the USA and the coming dissolution of the EU shaping this new scramble and partitioning of Africa in the longer term? What economy and socio-politics do we need to make sense of such seismic shifts at the global level and scale? How are globalization and financialization of global capital interrelated and shaping them? What interventions and recommendations can we make for transforming and transcending this Hemispheric and world-historical system-world and the contemporary chaos it generates?

Africa is where it all began, humanly speaking. From the standpoint of the world-economy, Africa is the cradle of the entire world-system. It is the land from which, like the planet itself, the rest of the continents of our common world have evolved and devolved. It is with that deep perspective in mind that I turn to the vexed issue of China's, Russia's and America's roles in the 21st Century scramble and partition of Africa from a finance and economic engineering perspective, while also speaking to its longer civilizational roots in ethics, theology, philosophy,

metaphysics, spirituality and religion in ways so far only adumbrated via decolonial and Islamicate critiques and praxes.

1.1. Background and Context

In this paper, we are interested in political risk due to security and have viewed superpowers as financiers and risk specialists willing to price in risk in specific geographic spaces. Using a blockchain and mathematical theory, financiers' action allows us to reverse-engineer the underlying governance and infrastructure of states and territories, including the claimed regions of rival superpowers. Then, it blueprints the aftermath of the colonial scramble and the likely territorial reconfiguration of the ca. 50 fragile African countries on a five-year horizon. North Africa has already been (re-)baked, as have the most stable two dozen African countries as "pancaked" entities.

In the context of the 21st Century Pax Atomica, African countries have been warred over the past decade – most notably through proxy sub-state actors fighting on behalf of superpowers – and absorbed into formal and informal spheres of influence that offer lucrative financial or raw material rewards to the sponsoring superpower at potentially enormous costs paid by the subsidiary African entities, including the cost of partition. Following a brief review of the problem situation of the Scramble for Africa as of 6 May 2020, the "Consequences: Peace, Security, and Arms Control Implications" section will then establish the security economics of the modern scramble, showing that risk-in-premium – which mirrors the level of security-in-peace offered by proto-state governance – ports deflationary security and economic geo-regional consequences as the entire claimed territories and claimed political orders of some 60 de facto states are expected to shatter.

1.2. Purpose and Scope

Rationale for a Financial and Economic Engineering Analysis of the Geopolitical Dynamics in Africa

The purpose of the present essay is to conduct an overview of the 21st Century Scramble and partition of Africa and its transition from a peripheral space in the world system to a semi-peripheral space in terms of Wallerstein's Modern system through the lenses of a scholar who deals with Finance and Economic Engineering. When geopolitical facts take place, as in the case of the withdrawal of the United States from Afghanistan, due to several reasons, the immediate response in the financial markets spans from total indifference to reactions that could settle

themselves either in more peace and tranquillity or in increased risk perceptions which could reflect in the growing or dropping values of the exchange rates or stock or bond prices. Therefore, in classical finance, one will search for any relationship between geopolitical events and stock price movements. However, an underlying value-destruction process might be valued using options pricing theory due to the underlying call to put options on ecological resources. And it is this destructive process that this work shall study, signifying its originality.

This paper shall attempt to introduce and detail the design of a normative model capturing the essence of what we call "the 21st Century Scramble and partition of Africa." Due to the intrinsic lack of sound data on how the respective appropriations, partages, or even partitions had been organised and experienced, the paper will delimit its model's background to the case of socialist countries with democratic transition, like Romania. However, the model could be further developed for the myriad of alternative prospective cases in Africa. What are the proposed blocks of analysis resulting from a dialectic concerning some comparative elements between this "21st-century appropriation and partition of Africa's resources and the 19th-20th century' Scramble?

2. Historical Context

For centuries, Africa has been at the crossroads or vanguard of socio-political and economic history. When one charts the course or trajectory of the economic destinies of many African countries—take Ghana, Uganda, and El Salvador, for example—one tangentially touches on inter-European issues. The intrigue is not only phenomenal, but it also shapes patterns in the international political economy. This is because power relations and balances in Europe largely determine positive outcomes and reject the possibility of some economic engineering taking place within the peripheries. It was not by chance that European powers decided to meet in Berlin from November 15, 1884, to February 26, 1885. They agreed then to divide Africa amongst themselves and, thus, initiated the scramble for Africa in the 19th century.

The objective of this paper is to revisit the 19th Century Scramble for Africa, also known as the partition of "the dark continent" or "the last outpost of civilisation." A good mastery of the issues surrounding the partition of Africa gives a new understanding of certain sociopolitical constructs in the world of the 19th century and beyond. On the contrary, some argue that Africa's partition and historical development in the 19th century were not uncoordinated phenomena. Instead, inter-European politics and diplomacy were the cause of these events both on and

off the continent. The postponement and temporary stalemate in the partitioning and overall control of the more significant parts of Africa underscored the importance of European politics in African affairs. If, however, we assume that these same states, and others who came later on the African scene, embarked on their colonial policy to make financial and human resources available to international commerce as a sort of by-product, the pursuit of "finance capital" in any case became inextricably interwoven, checked and balanced by the expense of maintaining and controlling political regimes.

2.1. 19th Century Scramble for Africa

After the European regional partition of the globe at the Berlin Conference of 1884-1885, the European colonial nations tended towards what some authors describe as the 'old' colonial expansion. The German publicist Kurt Samuel Lowdermilk (1887-1983) gave a radio programme between 1932 and 1935. The Scramble for Africa was a period of significant upheaval in the continent's history. It could be divided into two major phases. Five West European colonial nations, competing for mercantile and colonial dominance, were the principal actors of the first phase; this scramble involving two other colonial players finally led to the division of Africa among the European colonial powers. The colonial policy and action, as well as the international treaty which resulted from it, evidenced a series of internal contradictions between the aim of colonising Africa and the colonial agents' economic-financial and geographical interests.

The scheduling of the partition of Africa by the colonial nations appeared during the Fifteenth International Conference of Geography; the protection of America against the design being at the origin, at least in family circles, of the first ideas of a subvention of the enterprise. At this conference, the French geographer Élisée Reclus elaborated the third conference of the preliminary report, "The Practical Study of Geography in the Public School," published by A. Biett in 1875 under the title "The Practical Study of Geography in the French Primary Schools," as a continuation of the studies published under the direction of É. Reclus as part of the work "The Student of the French Colonial Empire."

2.2. 20th Century Influence and Legacy

Davidson writes that the 19th-century scramble for Africa continued to be one of the most critical influences on the African continent in the 20th century. A significant legacy of the 19th century was the drawing of new boundaries across Africa, which modern states and colonial territories collected or inherited from the overlaid blueprints. At the same time, even after independence was gained by

most African territories in the 1960s, the Western powers maintained specific power structures that they transferred to vassal states or client states. In his study of the diplomacy of partition in Africa, Sherlock mentions that the 19th-century European politicians and rulers saw empire as the sinew of war.

Sherlock mentions that Arnold Toynbee and Daniel Boorstin, in their reports on the Congo at the time of the Berlin Conference, described the political entities in Europe as more of a marketplace than states. At the same time, European powers ruled over most of Asia and Africa. Toynbee's solution was for the weak to conquer these significant areas of the world. The weak, which he referred to as powers of Congress, he took to mean the European powers plus the US. Toynbee was disillusioned with the imperial powers and came close to saying that civilisation is impossible this year if the British Arrestment of too small farmers of Bengal, which he considered a neo-feudal system not far removed from medieval Europe, and the Euro-American neo-feudal system in which the colonising powers had a significant share.

3. The Rise of China, Russia, and America in Africa

For well over half a century, China, Russia, and America had no innate interest in Africa and Africans. The 'negative' attitude of the West in general and of the United States in particular towards the 'dark continent' is public knowledge. Russia and the Soviet Union, of which it was writ large, had been similarly dismissive of Africans and Africa. Given Mao Tse Tung's universalist leanings, China's perceptions of Africans were extraordinary. However, the Chinese largely viewed the people of Africa either as under-developed peoples that needed to be defended against Western imperialism - and, by proxy, the United States - or as people that had been exploited and subjugated by Western powers. At best, the world's three leading powers viewed Africa just as the world's leading superpower does at the moment of writing (i.e., 2021) – as a marginal actor on the fringes of the international system.

All that changed somewhat with The New Partnership for African Development (NEPAD), which hit the ground running at the beginning of the 21st century principally because the African Union has chosen to communicate with the international community in the language and lore of market liberalisation and demystifying the irrational exuberance of Western foreign direct investors. A few years before NEPAD, however, the first of just nine or so Chinese 'state banks' opened and had a stranglehold in Africa backed by The Chinese Ex-Im rather

apposite definition of The Belt and Road Initiative sees it as an overarching strategy to marshal the availability of the 'Liquidity surpluses of the world'.

3.1. Economic Interests and Investments

According to the Observatory of Economic Complexity (OEC), which provides sources from the International Trade Centre (ITC), the structure of Chinese goods exports to the US reveals that 16.6% of Chinese exports to the US constitute primary commodities, the bulk of which are from Africa, led by the exports of petroleum products. These items are labelled categories 27 (crude petroleum) and 26 (oil seed, oily fruits, grains, seed, medicinal plants, straw and fodder).

As for China's investments, while much of the data is a 'black box', we know that China's investments in Ethiopia exceed 51% of the gross national debt of Ethiopia, amounting to $52.06 billion. If the offshore labelled confidential debts were to be considered, the total Chinese debt would be $65.8 billion. We also know that, according to the outstanding debt stock data generated from the Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative (EITI), 48.61% of the outstanding debt belongs to Chinese banks, with petroleum taking the lead in the energy sector.

In summarising and looking from the perspective of financial flows, the interest of Russia to be in Africa is captured well by Belarus. It should be read within the geopolitical shift that led Putin to rebalance his presence in Africa and be 'under the radar' of the US and China, with the presence of Russian technocrats in various banks and funds operating in Anglo-Saxon-consolidated regions. On the other side, China and its fast-rising financial flows showed more focus on being efficiently present in large Anglo-Saxon-consolidated areas such as South Africa. Though American banks have historically dominated the region, financial flows are instead being diverted within the region through a globalisation of formal and informal financial syndicates that involve China and Russia as the focal players.

3.2. Political and Strategic Motivations

The China-Russia partnership: Competition with the U.S. and opportunities and challenges for the developing world - What can be learned from Russia’s experience in economic transformation? This calls attention to the enormous impact of the US on global geopolitics. The reason for this US monopoly rests on three things: a potent military-industrial complex amounting to more than the cumulative total of the rest of the world; a formidable technological and scientific base; and its control over the world’s key sources of energy, mainly the Gulf Arab oil and gas, and Venezuela. China and Russia are endeavouring to challenge this

global structure. Both recognise that this is not possible without approaching and partnering with Africa.

Political and strategic motivation:

China's new engagement in Africa is a move to challenge this global structure by enhancing development partnerships with many African nations, as China is aware that the bulk of the world's resources and essential raw materials dwell there. Russia predominantly relies on exporting its oil, minerals, and armaments to South Africa and other African countries. For Russian economic survival, it will positively seek alternative manifestations to the established order in the financial and energy domain. Under Donald Trump, the US wants to revitalise its global leadership role. "Make America Great Again" articulates its strategic realpolitik, and the Build Back Better World [BBBW] is one of its policy instruments that will help these ends. Boosting its global competitiveness through finance and economic engineering is the backdrop. Geopolitical and strategic motivations drive the three powers. The question that looms large is the nature of capital and finance engineering and the implications that underlie these policy approaches.

4. Finance and Economic Engineering in Africa

This essay aims to provide an informed viewpoint to understand Africa's problems better today. Having carried out the previous activity on designing the institutions to fill the gaps between authority and power in Africa, in Part I, we now transition towards the processes and practice of financial or economic engineering and finance within Africa to assess what is happening within the continent. Here, it is pertinent to explore the plans of foreign actors in Africa attempting to transform the socioeconomic formations of states, in part through investment. The activities of these actors in Africa are centred on infrastructure and development of rail, ports, and other transport and logistics, as well as mining resource extraction. A few seconds should also be spared for EU-Africa deals and trade agreements.

Let us then, for a moment, reflect on what constitutes African co-production. In our view, African co-production should only be those activities to which Africans decide they are endogenous. There are West African initiatives to produce sustainable development among the countries of West Africa. ECOWAS-UEMOA is a product of endogenous activity among the nations of West Africa to create and foster regional economic and monetary integration. The rest we can argue in some form is a form of being busy doing finance. Concisely, the New Scramble and

Partition of Africa, which has been taking place in forms layered over and in different locations in contemporary Africa, including oil palm land grabs, the privatisation of vital industries, the neoliberal death of African nation-states, and so forth, is also prone to take the form of investments in infrastructure such as rail networks, rail lines, trains and carriages, port-based infrastructure like cranes, financing projects, large dams, schools, hospitals, and airports, foreign direct investment in mines, and many other forms. The following section further describes and details these finance and economic engineering activities.

4.1. Infrastructure Development

This is the first finance and economic engineering consequence that follows globalisation, the 21st-century scramble, and partitions of Africa by the European Union, China, Russia, the United States and the United Kingdom. In the name of investment, the European Union (EU) recorded $632.7 billion (2016), $1.62 trillion (2015) and $1.1 trillion (2014) worth of foreign direct investment (FDI) stock in Africa. China signed 42 trade and investment cooperation agreements worth $3.4 billion with African countries during the three-day summit on China-Africa trade and investment in Zhejiang province in November 2010, and the terms and size of these projects can be enormous. The United States of America and Russia are currently investing $200 billion in Africa, particularly in infrastructure and quality services development. For instance, as of 2015, the Exim Bank of China had handed $14.347 billion out of a total of $74.443 billion in loans, mainly targeted at infrastructure development across the plains of Africa.

Engineering: Experts once more suggest that the 21st Century scramble and partitions of Africa might bring about a broad construction of the means of transportation: roads, rail lines, ports, and airports. Given that Africa's internal African trade is meagre (4.8 per cent), the issue of upgrading air transport via the engineering of airports will surely attract Africans and non-Africans. Africans should not just concentrate on trade in goods but also essential services because, generally, the liberalisation of trade in services has generated significant trade surpluses for developed countries across and within continents. For instance, the engineering of airports to be auto-regulated can make airport operations and forex profitable for Africa. This is possible with China's equity investment of about $340 million and a further loan of $85 million. This expansion project includes a new terminal, a VIP lounge, and other facilities. These are the engineering footprints found in Morocco. For instance, a consortium of Egyptian, Emirati, and Kuwaiti companies with experience in airport engineering have signed an agreement to

finance the airport's construction. It will need some $130 million to develop the airport overall. The project will be carried out in four phases. The first phase, in which the terminal will be built, has already begun. It should be finished in 18 months. The second and third phases entail setting up an 11-km road into the terminal and constructing an industrial zone close to the airport. In the fourth phase, hotels will be built west of the airport.

4.2. Resource Extraction and Trade Agreements

The financial/trade frontier: International trade agreements

Africa is the leading natural resource of value suppliers in which a higher level of free market anarchy (and thus commodities and services) within an informal market nexus infrastructural environment of productive trade networks appeals to trading partners. Dependence or exploitation might be a flyfish hook in the meat, but the problem is that the leading Westphalian state owner would not share that result. Deepening trade relations in natural resource trade, infrastructure, and value finance of trade specialisation means a more than cosy relationship. Liberal global-complexity hypercompetitive finance-led trade integration is not going to aid human-contrived' physical code-based complex subsystem of a biogenetical general system in which one faction (consisting of extra-systemic and systemic environments) has a set of laws negotiated with something as big as itself.

International free and fair trade exists at civil conflation non-Coase competitive chaos uni-man (n+S) infrastructure and its cohering supra-national (S-n) trade agreements such as the European Union and refined WAEMU (the CFA Franc Zone countries). It is a trade region where all states own harmonisation of multifarious monetary characteristics and demand for each other's goods. These united nations trade in fixed par Manning trade bloc through value-added trade networks and enterprise monetarism - regimes of floating trade standardisation reflected on other trading states impasses of their doctrines and bloating lines of homogeneity at civil rival empire. This liberal model is fast emerging as a contending financial and trade model through IBSA and BRICS. It is a viable global platform of noble trade standard agreements because its ambition is inclusive and participative.

5. Challenges and Controversies

The nature of these planned financings and projects, which involve a substantial financial injection for the upgrading and new infrastructure build, indicates that these transactions will include debt in a financial structure. This means that a

process of economic engineering will be taking place. Added to this is the Big Push strategy forwarded by almost no one in the African Political and Economic Circle. This does allow voices to be raised that either the debt would be unsustainable, that Africa would become dependent on external donors, or that the debt would mainly contribute to adverse environmental and social impacts, thus invalidating the strategy.

If Africa's scramble and partition by the US, China, and Russia were to happen by the 21st century, it would involve different dimensions. These include finance and economy, which stem from the undeniable truth that resources are the basis of power and political and military might that come from the endowment of nature or capital. Challenges and controversies may arise in this discourse, calling for a global solution, or in this case, some world system countries. This could relate to debt sustainability, economic dependency, or negative externalities from the plan's operation. These can't be avoided but can be lessened or removed altogether.

5.1. Debt Sustainability and Economic Dependency

After a return rate set above the economic growth rate G, there are already positive external effects on the project's lender. Africa is a damaging precedent that the international finance surveillance community fears that it may justify, in its first instance, relativisations of the determining suitable debt policy measures which have been calculated for individual projects. Indeed, using data from the World Bank and China Africa Research Initiative (CARI), it is remarked that China gives the other flow to the debt-ridden and oil-rich countries of the quiet neighbour in the study.

In rallying international soccer players in the OR Tambo hall, he also briefed players about the items reported on the 'Chinese international' website that Sika will be coming to Ghana and proffered the entire United Nations Organization (FAO) interest. Comments now turn to the nature of the paper of the missing continent, grounded in the immense or institutional conditions of the financial use of critical features processes. This joint venture between these fund managers turned a whopping $114.5 B profit in 2011, partly from twenty-five African countries! At the same time, the Chinese are setting up enterprises to push Africa into greater economic dependency.

5.2. Environmental and Social Impacts

The environmental and social impacts of the new scramble of Africa have emerged as a controversial and much-debated subject. The investments coming from outside, including China, emissaries of other governments, and global companies, are acquiring access to and control of Africa's resources. Different lobbies and interests have evolved to defend their bent of mind and interest. Those with little or no knowledge and personal experience of being in Africa and relying upon secondary sources, mostly newspaper reports, tend to generalise, put everybody in one basket, and neglect domestic dynamics at both ends of the business partnerships.

In the contested debate, some see the dealings with Africa as a civilisation threat, some as a valuable expansion for the growing population, and as a consequence of growing scarcity. Though desirability and practicality often get mixed up, the implicit expectation is probably that proponents of a new north-south or south-north axis will jointly try to cut corners about their own proclaimed or basic principles such as respect for environmental, human, and Indigenous Peoples' rights. Others see the partnerships as both a threat and an opportunity; this article explores the socio-economic and ecological impacts of these partnerships from a finance and economic engineering point of view.

Those supporting the investments in commodities impart the need for access to resources. The International Energy Agency (IEA; OECD, 2006) anticipated that in three decades, resources would be increasingly challenging to locate and access, and hence, the big energy companies attempted to build an oligopolistic regime for the long-term security of supply. After having stated for several decades that it was possible to satisfy the energy demand with conventional (mostly fossil and nuclear) sources, the WEC released a first high-profile report in 1993, stating that to meet the world's energy requirements, it was necessary to depend more on natural gas and non-conventional oil. Major international agencies such as IEA (OECD, 2003, 2004, 2005; IEA, 2006), WEC (World Energy Council policy statements, WEC, 1993), and the currently developing Global Energy Assessment (GEA, IIASA, 2011) aware of the finite character of the earth resources have been promoting the development and investments in no less risky and resource-consuming renewable alternative sources to be accompanied with severe attempts to alleviate demand or, in better words, to curtail or reduce supply. Still, the importance of energy policy tends to be given to "funding", where the term can imply various meanings: investment, credit, money, economic, and monetary

system (currency, banking, taxation, etc.), etc. For instance, ecohydrological, institutional, and energy funds are the financial institutions or tools related directly or indirectly to mitigating the environmental and social impacts of energy and transport supply.

6. Future Prospects and Recommendations

The future does not look bright for Africa. Evidence indicates that normative and altruistic reasons are unlikely to prevail in the minds of the international superpowers, but only realist reasons. No moral principle, human rights, or other burning concerns have shaped the superpowers' economic policies or investment practices. The prospects of Africa rest in a more balanced and stable relationship between the leading nations. Self-restraint from going too far in exploitation and marauding and cooperation in the development process in accordance with people's actual needs would make Africa a happy place for investment and development. The role of governance in Africa can also not be underestimated. Therefore, the role of the internal African stakeholders in promoting responsible international behaviour by other actors cannot be ignored.

However, to achieve these objectives, African countries will have to become much more efficient when engaging with powerful international actors. The more powerful an entity, more excellent care should be taken, and more informed decisions should be made. For Africa, the strategic choices will also determine the type of development pursued in the long term. Should Africa negotiate competitively or transact collaboratively? Africans must decide what mix of the two to adopt and how to navigate among various forces. Decisions will also depend on where Africa wants to invest now, both in the immediate and long term. Wealth and power are fickle. The two giants of yesterday – the Soviet Union and the United States – are finding it hard to succeed internationally in making the respectability of the other one disappear. Future considerations can only leave Africa in a pickle if it relies on solid powers. That is unlikely to do much for it. Africa can only despise the balance-of-power system, which left a weak Ukraine in a catch-22 situation. Africa must hope and work towards the spread of cooperation among pairs. For this, it must reward those nations that engage in developmental practices in their domains. Economic growth is essential, but sustainable development is vital. There is growing African resentment at foreign exploitation. It will spur the African dream of an 'all-Africa conference' with the whites and all foreign investors in a future in Africa. The investments will be resource-friendly and African-led, enhancing the perpetual exploitation of

resources. In the future, the superpowers will be lured by the common good and resources well acquired. Policies in the long term shall not only plan for profit but also the well-being of humans, including Rwandan school-children among other children growing up in abject poverty. Development is not money-spinner projects but well-spread and inclusive development for all, no matter how remote. African policymakers of today should coach their populace in the politics of longevity.

Future African prospects are dependent variables with several independent variables that interact among themselves, but they can be broadly divided into geopolitical and economic variables. African policymakers must learn to do everything in moderation because they can affect either negative or positive African futures. In short, African prospects appear more of a boolean than a continuous function. We have tried to put socio-economic and political development indicators, global finance and investment trends and practices into a stand-alone narrative. However, the overall prospects of Africa are so interwoven that the African policymaker, while reading the essay, should have them in mind. The future beckons Africans to decide where they want their countries to be, including today's infants and school children of 2022.

6.1. Balancing Economic Growth with Sustainable Development

At the lowest level of ABCD, the challenge that Sub-Saharan Africa has confronted for decades, if not centuries, is reconciling the goals of pragmatics and the intellect. That is, reconciling the demands of material well-being with the least-squares matrix of the eco-social systems. The international community has been wrestling with the Millennium Development Goals (MDG) and the broader United Nations (UN) 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development Goals (SDG) and Agenda 2063. In the Madisonian spirit, I would be hesitant, at best, to venture too far into the field of dreams. One thing, however, is for sure: Nations continue to draw up "Vision" or "Action" plans for centuries into the future, but these dreams never endure past the first adversities encountered, if they are implemented at all. Moreover, the very notion and utility of a vision of sustainability is antithetical and an oxymoron because it suggests that in envisioning a possible sustainable future, a negotiable and acceptable amount of [pre-sustainability] ecologically-astronomical flows are tolerable and are justifiably part and parcel of the vision. "Our vision is to be an environmentally-friendly awesome Five-, maybe Six-Star Hotel..."

Real prosperity is arguably more a matter of land or space endowment than FOMO, and real property in Africa has only been increasing in value by double

digits, no less—astronomically. "The earth can no longer deal with our race's destructive behaviour, a phenomenon that will eventually lead to the lands beginning to burn..." Intriguingly, Africa is paradoxically the only region at -1% catastrophic farmland expansion, although degraded areas are extensive. Given these developments, the mission of the African People and their Leaders should be to strike the perfect mechahuna from the jump to avoid negative social, human capital, and biological disasters of EPIC scope.

6.2. Enhancing International Cooperation and Governance

Andathsoukn, history was created, and it seems to be a succession of choices, behaviours, and attitudes, depending on whether options will allow something good or not. Understanding Africans with abundant values and working ethics and the embedded and hard-wired African Ubuntu, which is the wisdom of the spirit of heart in unity, diversity, and respect for all, could easily enhance international cooperation among countries. The global attitude will also ensure multilateral finance and investment for peace and an equitable financial engineering technology proliferation within the shared common space of the globe.

The essay "21st Century Scramble and Partition of Africa: China, Russia, and America – A Finance and Economic Engineering Perspective" extends deep knowledge and information in the context of Africa, finance, economics, international investments, and finance engineering into the Scramble and Partition of Africa that has been or is happening among the countries of China, Russia, and the USA as of being written in 2022.

Therefore, I have elaborated on and contributed to Africa's historical perspective before and after the colonial era. Moving forward, I've started with the current deals, the roots and making of the 21st-century Scramble and Partition of Africa, and analysed each potential partner's trade, investments, and lending projects towards Africa. I have then identified and categorised the pattern and the designs with hidden agendas, the likely block formations, and Africa's reactions and responses with policy measures while designing the likely African recommendations and the way forward.

The motives of undertaking this work are to embed prior historical knowledge, definitions, and frameworks, geopolitical interests and relations, Africa's political stability, economic spinning, and how individual business corporations and entire Africa could benefit or suffer from doing business with such powers who are

anxious with political power, technologies, and who implemented economics and finance engineering.

To successfully navigate the intricate challenges posed by colonisation and neo-colonization, it is imperative to establish a robust framework that promotes economic, social, financial, and political autonomy. By cultivating a mutually beneficial alliance with Russia, America, and China, Africa can confidently tackle the 21st-century scramble and partition, fostering a climate of equitable development. In this endeavour, a range of strategies can be explored to secure Africa's sovereignty and maximise its agency on the global stage.

Transparency and Accountability: It is of the utmost importance to ensure complete transparency and accountability in all agreements and partnerships with these countries, as this will play a significant role in safeguarding the interests and rights of the African people. By ensuring that every aspect of these collaborations is conducted transparently, we can effectively prevent any hidden agendas or attempts at exploitation. Through open and accountable governance, we can foster a sense of trust and confidence among the African population, which ultimately promotes sustainable development and equitable growth.

2. Strong Regulatory Frameworks: It is imperative for African nations to diligently implement robust and comprehensive regulatory frameworks to govern foreign investments and partnerships effectively. These frameworks play a vital role in safeguarding African interests, preventing any potential exploitative or predatory practices that may harm the continent's economic growth and development. By establishing strict regulations, African nations can ensure that foreign investments contribute positively to local economies, promote sustainable development, and prioritise the welfare of African citizens. Through these solid regulatory measures, Africa can foster a climate of fair and responsible foreign investments that benefit both the nations involved and the overall continent.

3. Local Capacity Building: The primary objective is to emphasise and prioritise the development of local capacity and skills through technology transfer, education, and training programs. Imparting such knowledge and expertise enables African nations to actively and meaningfully engage in a broad range of partnerships with foreign countries, thereby fostering collaboration and mutual growth on a global scale. These initiatives pave the way for sustainable advancements and long-term empowerment within Africa, ensuring a future brimming with limitless potential and opportunities.

4. The Importance of Diversification in Building Partnerships: To safeguard against the risks of over-reliance on any one country or region, it is crucial to diversify partnerships by forming connections with multiple countries. Doing so can effectively reduce our vulnerability to external pressures and ensure a more stable foundation for collaboration and cooperation. In today's interconnected world, where unforeseen challenges can arise, diversification of partnerships emerges as a strategic imperative that fosters resilience and enhances our ability to navigate complex global dynamics. Hence, embracing the idea of diversification and proactively forming relationships with a diverse range of countries is imperative, ultimately facilitating a more robust and sustainable network of partnerships.

5. Infrastructure Development: It is of the utmost importance to prioritise infrastructure development projects that benefit the local population, contribute to their overall well-being, and catalyse robust economic growth. By focusing on the needs and aspirations of our people, we can steer clear of solely serving the interests of foreign powers, ensuring that our infrastructure development initiatives are designed to empower our citizens and propel our nation towards a brighter and more prosperous future.

6. Fair Trade Agreements: Our primary objective lies in negotiating comprehensive, equitable, and just fair trade agreements that prioritise mutual benefit and demonstrate the utmost respect for Africa's rich resources and hardworking labour force. We are steadfast in our commitment to prevent any exploitation that may serve the interests of foreign powers, prioritising the welfare and prosperity of the African continent above all else. Through these transparent and ethical trade agreements, we strive to create a harmonious global economy that empowers African nations, fosters inclusive growth, and paves the way for a brighter future.

7. Investment in Research and Innovation: To drive economic growth and propel technological advancement within the vast continent of Africa, it is crucial to encourage and facilitate investment in research and innovation actively. This will boost the continent's self-reliance and resilience and reduce its heavy reliance on external actors for progress and development. By fostering a culture of innovation and supporting groundbreaking research initiatives, Africa can unlock its immense potential and establish itself as a global hub for cutting-edge technologies and groundbreaking discoveries. Such investments will create countless opportunities for indigenous talent and entrepreneurs and pave the way

for sustainable development and long-term prosperity throughout the African nations. Consequently, there is a pressing need for governments, organisations, and stakeholders from within and outside the continent to recognise the immense value and potential of investing in research and innovation as a catalyst for Africa's future success. With collaborative efforts and strategic investments, Africa can chart its course towards a brighter, more prosperous future independent of external influences.

8. Pan-African Unity: It is paramount to actively promote and encourage pan-African unity and cooperation, which will undeniably bolster the continent's bargaining power in any negotiations with foreign powers. By fostering a sense of togetherness and solidarity among African nations, we can ensure that our continent speaks and acts as one strong force on the international stage, propelling us towards a future characterised by shared growth, progress, and prosperity. Only through a unified approach to development can we effectively address Africa's challenges, paving the way for a brighter tomorrow where every nation thrives and every individual flourish. Let us seize this opportunity to galvanise our collective strength, working hand in hand towards a genuinely united Africa that embraces its diversity and turns it into a powerful catalyst for change. Together, we can reshape history, leaving a profound and indelible mark on our beloved continent for generations.

9. Civil Society Engagement: It is essential to actively engage civil society organisations, local communities, and other stakeholders in decision-making processes. This inclusive approach guarantees the recognition and value of their opinions while safeguarding their essential interests and concerns. By incorporating a broad range of perspectives, we strive to establish an environment that fosters collaboration, enabling the formulation of comprehensive and sustainable solutions rooted in diverse needs and aspirations. Together, by embracing the strength of unity, we can forge a path towards a better future that truly encompasses the whole of society.

10. Sustainable Development Goals: To effectively align partnerships and investments with the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals, it is crucial to ensure that they contribute to long-term sustainable development and yield far-reaching benefits for all segments of society. By focusing on these goals, we can collectively eradicate poverty, promote inclusivity, enhance economic growth, ensure environmental sustainability, and foster peace and justice. Together, through our concerted efforts, we can create a brighter and more equitable future

for generations to come, bridging gaps and fostering a harmonious society where each individual thrives. Remember, it is through collective action and collaboration that we can truly achieve the vision of a sustainable and prosperous world for all.

By strategically implementing and embracing these carefully crafted strategies, African nations can successfully navigate and effectively manage their valuable partnerships with Russia, America, China, and various other influential countries in the mesmerising 21st-century scramble for the vast continent of Africa. Through this astute approach, they can preserve their hard-earned independence while fostering and nurturing a harmonious environment of mutual benefit, thus establishing a remarkable win-win partnership that paves the way for Africa's prosperous future.